

Wednesday, 9 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 19° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 17° 12°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 17° 12°	GLASGOW Overcast 16° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Britain has announced sanctions against Israeli settlers in the West Bank, sparking a furious response from Israel.

The Foreign Secretary accused settlers of 'ethnic cleansing' of Palestinians. In retaliation, Israel has shut down the UK consulate in East Jerusalem.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Prince Harry and Meghan say they were 'surprised' by a letter from the King, confirming they remain non-working royals.

A spokesperson for the couple stated they had no prior warning about the letter. However, palace sources have denied this claim.

ROYALS · UK
- 3

A 78-year-old British widow is facing deportation from Sweden after living there for 22 years.

She failed to complete a Brexit residence application on time. This case highlights the ongoing challenges faced by some UK citizens living in EU countries.

BREXIT · UK
- 4

An 83-year-old man from Scotland has been jailed after being found with over two million child abuse images.

Police discovered the vast collection on multiple devices at his home in Stenhousemuir. He was described as having the 'largest hoard' ever found in Scotland.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Prince George has marked a significant milestone, attending his first day at Eton College.

The 13-year-old was dropped off at the prestigious all-boys boarding school by his parents, Prince William and Princess Catherine of Wales.

ROYALS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Glastonbury Festival has confirmed its ticket sale dates for next year, with prices hitting an all-time high.**

The iconic festival will return in June after its traditional fallow year. Tickets for 2027 have now topped £400 for the first time.

ON AIR – Are you planning to brave the ticket scramble, or is the price just getting too steep now?

MUSIC · 2027

2 **Nigella Lawson is being praised as the new judge on The Great British Bake Off, as the latest contestants are announced.**

The much-loved TV chef joins the show for its 17th series. A fresh batch of hopefuls will be battling it out to be crowned Star Baker.

ON AIR – What do you think of Nigella joining the tent? Who are you hoping to see among the new contestants?

TV · AUTUMN

3 **Great news for fans of The Inbetweeners, as Netflix has confirmed a new film with the original cast set to return!**

The beloved coming-of-age sitcom characters will be back for another big-screen adventure. Details are still under wraps, but anticipation is already building.

ON AIR – Which Inbetweeners character are you most excited to see back on screen? What kind of chaos do you think they'll get into this time?

FILM · COMING SOON

4 **Andrew Scott is feeling the 'pressure' playing an 'unsung hero' in a new World War Two thriller.**

The actor reveals he's portraying James Stagg, the meteorologist whose crucial forecasts were key to the success of D-Day. It sounds like a gripping role.

ON AIR – Andrew Scott is always brilliant, isn't he? What's your favourite role of his so far?

FILM · COMING SOON

5 **Sir Tom Jones has revealed he 'didn't want to leave' The Voice, despite his on-off role on the show.**

The Welsh singing legend has been a coach on the competition since it first premiered in 2012. He's always a firm favourite with viewers.

ON AIR – Do you think The Voice is the same without Sir Tom? Which coach do you think has been the best?

TV · ONGOING

On the schedule

- 1 Great Britain's Matthew Brennan has sprinted to his fourth stage victory in the 2026 Vuelta a Espana.**
 Brennan continues to dominate the Spanish Grand Tour with another impressive performance. He's certainly making a name for himself in the cycling world.
ON AIR – Could Matthew Brennan be the next big British cycling star? Are you following the Vuelta this year?
 CYCLING · UK
- 2 Rangers captain Lawrence Shankland is set for a lengthy spell on the sidelines, potentially for up to four months.**
 The Scotland forward has suffered a hamstring tear and may require surgery. This is a significant blow for Rangers and for Shankland himself.
ON AIR – How big a loss is Shankland for Rangers, and who do you think will step up in his absence?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Reigning champions Arsenal came from behind to beat big-spending Chelsea in a pulsating London derby.**
 The Gunners secured a vital victory at the Emirates Stadium. It was a thrilling encounter that lived up to all expectations.
ON AIR – What a game that was! Did you expect Arsenal to come back and win, or were you backing Chelsea?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Ainsley Maitland-Niles scored a stunning stoppage-time equaliser to rescue a point for Everton against Manchester United.**
 His brilliant goal marked his return to English football in dramatic fashion. Everton came from behind twice in a resilient performance.
ON AIR – What a way to make a comeback! Is this the kind of impact Everton fans have been hoping for from Maitland-Niles?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 Manchester City's Women's Super League title defence is off to a perfect start with a victory over newly promoted Birmingham City.**
 A double from Shaw secured the win, setting a strong tone for the season ahead. City will be looking to maintain their dominance.
ON AIR – Are Manchester City the team to beat in the WSL again this season? Who do you think will challenge them for the title?
 FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful new trend sees people creating 'miniature libraries' for their garden gnomes.**
These tiny book nooks, filled with miniature books and even tiny reading lamps, are popping up in gardens across the country, much to the amusement of neighbours and garden visitors. It's bringing a touch of literary charm to the garden gnome community!
- 2 The humble 'picnic blanket' is having a surprising style moment.**
No longer just for sandy sandwiches, designers are now crafting bespoke, beautifully patterned picnic blankets that double as statement pieces for outdoor gatherings and even cosy throws indoors. Perfect for an impromptu al fresco lunch!
- 3 More people are embracing the joy of 'slow walking' to truly appreciate their surroundings.**
Instead of rushing, enthusiasts are deliberately slowing their pace, taking time to notice details in nature and architecture. It's a wonderful way to de-stress and reconnect with the world around us, one mindful step at a time.
- 4 A quirky new study suggests that listening to 'the sound of distant church bells' can reduce stress levels.**
Researchers found that the gentle, rhythmic chimes have a calming effect, promoting a sense of peace and reflection. Perhaps it's time to seek out a village green and just listen for a while!
- 5 The charming tradition of 'leaving anonymous notes of kindness' in public places is spreading smiles.**
From uplifting messages tucked into library books to compliments left on car windscreens, these small gestures are brightening days and fostering a lovely sense of community. A little kindness goes a long way!
- 6 A fascinating report highlights the growing popularity of 'miniature railway gardens' in private homes.**
Enthusiasts are dedicating sections of their gardens to intricate model railway tracks, complete with tiny stations, tunnels, and landscapes. It's a fantastic blend of gardening and hobby modelling, creating truly enchanting spaces.
- 7 More people are discovering the joy of 'upcycling old suitcases' into stylish furniture or pet beds.**
With a bit of creativity, these forgotten travel companions are being transformed into quirky side tables, comfortable resting spots for furry friends, or unique storage solutions. It's a great way to give vintage items a new lease of life!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuit will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE TAP ON THE SIDE, JUST TO 'TEST' ITS CRUNCHINESS!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm piece of toast, especially if it's got a new topping. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING THE TOPPING INTO A PERFECTLY SYMMETRICAL PATTERN, EVEN IF IT'S JUST JAM!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'shop or small business' just has a really unique and comforting smell?**

What's a specific smell that instantly transports you to a favourite local shop, and what kind of shop is it? Is it the scent of fresh bread from the bakery, old books from an antique shop, or something else entirely?

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do on a weekday morning that just make the day feel like it's started right, don't we?**

What's one small, perhaps quirky, thing you do every morning that sets you up for the day, whether it's a specific cup, a particular piece of music, or a peculiar breakfast combination?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that if you feed a goldfish regularly enough, it can eventually learn to recognise its owner's face?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogoch, in Wales.
- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- There is a town in Norway called 'Hell'.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth.
- Bees can be trained to detect bombs.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896; it lasted only 38 minutes.

On this day

Day 252 of the year, 113 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles Lowder (Church of England); Christian feast day: Ciarán of Clonmacnoise; Christian feast day: Blessed Eurythimia Üffing; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisco Gárate Aranguren. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1987 — Nicole Aniston, American actress and model
- 1990 — Jordan Tabor, English footballer (died 2014)
- 1947 — Freddy Weller, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1943 — Frank Clark, English footballer, manager and chairman
- 1940 — Joe Negroni, American doo-wop singer (died 1978)
- 1945 — Doug Ingle, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player (died 2024)
- 1981 — Julie Gonzalo, Argentine-American actress
- 1986 — Timothy Granaderos, American actor and model

THE DAY TODAY

- 2012 — A wave of attacks kills more than 100 people and injure 350 others across Iraq.
- 2025 — Several Russian drones incur on Polish airspace and are subsequently shot down, marking the first time a NATO member has engaged Russian military assets.
- 1971 — The four-day Attica Prison riot begins, eventually resulting in 39 dead, most killed by state troopers retaking the prison.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2014 — The album Songs of Innocence by U2 is digitally released at no charge to all customers of the iTunes Music Store, appearing automatically in the "purchased" section of over 500 million users worldwide.
- 1988 — Vietnam Airlines Flight 831 crashes in Khu Khot, Thailand, while on approach to Don Muang International Airport, killing 76.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2012 — A wave of attacks kills more than 100 people and injure 350 others across Iraq.
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1970 — A British airliner is hijacked by the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine and flown to Dawson's Field in Jordan.

- 1993 — Israeli–Palestinian peace process: The Palestine Liberation Organization officially recognizes Israel as a legitimate state.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 253 of the year, 112 days left in 2026. Today Amerindian Heritage Day (Guyana); Children's Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Alexander Crummell (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Ambrose Barlow. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1942 — Danny Hutton, Irish-American singer
- 1960 — David Lowery, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1958 — Chris Columbus, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1949 — Barriemore Barlow, English rock drummer and songwriter
- 1970 — Paula Kelley, American singer-songwriter
- 1995 — Jack Grealish, English footballer
- 1969 — Johnathon Schaech, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1948 — Judy Geeson, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1961 — A President Airlines Douglas DC-6 crashes just after takeoff from Shannon Airport, Ireland. All 83 passengers and crew are killed.
- 1937 — Nine nations attend the Nyon Conference to address international piracy in the Mediterranean Sea.
- 2007 — Former Prime Minister of Pakistan Nawaz Sharif returns to Pakistan after seven years in exile, following a military coup in October 1999.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2025 — American right-wing political activist Charlie Kirk is assassinated while onstage at Utah Valley University in Orem, Utah.
- 2001 — During his appearance on the British TV game show *Who Wants to be a Millionaire?*, contestant Charles Ingram reaches the £1 million top prize, but it was later revealed that he had cheated to the top prize by listening to coughs from his wife and another contestant.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar